

5. Which of the following is the earliest holy book of Jain?

- (a) Twelve Angas (b) Twelve Upangas
(c) Fourteen Purvas (d) Fourteen Uppurva

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The Fourteen Purvas is the ancient Jain scripture, which was preached by all Tirthankaras. At the time of the last Nand Ruler, Sambhootvijay and Bhadrabahu were the presidents of the Sangha. These two were the last to possess knowledge about the ancient Jain texts 14 Purvas given by Mahavira.

6. The first disciple of Lord Mahavira was –

- (a) Jamali (b) Yashoda
(c) Bipin (d) Prabhash

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Among the early visitors to Mahavira during his wandering was Jamali, his son-in-law. Jamali met Mahavira while the later was in Kshatriya- Kundagram, the village where Mahavira was born. He took the vow together with five hundred of the warrior caste. Jamali was the first disciple of Lord Mahavira.

7. 'Ajivaka', sect was founded by:

- (a) Anand (b) Rahulabhadra
(c) Makkhali Gosala (d) Upali

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Makkhali Gosala was a disciple of Mahavira in the early period, later fell out with Mahavira due to the difference of opinion with him and founded an independent creed "Ajivaka." The belief of the sect is known as 'Niyatiwad' according to which every matter in the world is being controlled and operated by destiny (fate).

8. Who used the caves of Barabar as their shelter-house?

- (a) Ajivakas (b) Tharus
(c) Jains (d) Tantrikas

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The act of cutting the mountain caves and developing them as residences was fully developed during the period of Ashoka and his grandson Dasaratha. Residences were made for Ajivaka followers after cutting the hills of Barabar and Nagarjuni.

9. Who of the following kings was strongly inclined towards Jainism?

- (a) Dasaratha (b) Brihadrath
(c) Kharavel (d) Huvishk

(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Kharavel, the Chedi dynasty ruler of Kalinga was one of the greatest emperors in ancient India history. An inscription without date has been received from the 'Hathigumpha' of the Udayagiri hill, located three miles from Bhubaneswar in Odisha province. This record is the only source to know the history of Kharavel. It had a heavy inclination towards Jainism. The Hathigumpha inscription is in Prakrit Language.

10. Gorathagiri in the Barabar Hills was conquered by

- (a) Rajaraja Chola (b) Kharavela
(c) Menander (d) Pushyamitra Sunga
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

Gorathagiri in the Barabar Hill was conquered by Emperor Kharavela. Kharavela was the greatest king of the Mahameghavahana dynasty of Kalinga, it was an ancient ruling dynasty of Kalinga after the decline of the Mauryan Empire. The primary source for Kharavela is the Hathigumpha inscription Udaygiri.

Shaiva, Bhagavata Religion

1. Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made devotional religion popular in

- (a) Northern India (b) Southern India
(c) Eastern India (d) Western India

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made Bhakti (devotional) religion popular in Northern India. They criticised the ritual and other aspects of conventional religion and the social order. They also advocated renunciation of the world.

2. Who contributes the most in the development of Bhagavata sect?

- (a) Persian (b) Indo-Greek people
(c) Kushan (d) Gupta

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The Bhagavata or Vaishnava religion reached its peak in the reign of Gupta kings. Gupta kings were follower of the Vaishnava religion, and they made it a religion of the state. Most of the Gupta rulers hold the title of 'Parambhagavata.' Garuda, the mount (Vahana) of Lord Vishnu was the state symbol of Guptas.